Monthly SEO Report Template

Five report sections with examples, a metrics table to fill in with data from Google Search Console and Google Analytics 4, and a red-flag checklist for whoever reads the report. Print the template, or send it to your agency as a list of what you expect to see in every monthly report.

How to use this template

1. **Lead with the business result.** The first number is customer inquiries from Google (form, phone, email) and the cost per inquiry. Clicks, rankings and work done come after that.
2. **Keep the summary to one page** (p. 2): the result against the goal, 3–5 causes with evidence, next month's plan and the risks. Charts and keyword tables belong in an appendix or the client portal.
3. **Give every number a source** the client can open on their own – ideally Search Console and Analytics accounts registered to the client's email address.
4. **Compare year over year.** Month-over-month growth during peak season is often just the calendar, not the effect of SEO.
5. **Log every task with a date and a page URL** (p. 3). A task name on its own, such as "on-page optimization," is not enough.
6. **The last page is for the reader.** Check the agency's report against this template and tick any red flags. Missing sections make good questions for your next meeting.

Report details

Company and website	
Report month	
Prepared by (agency, account manager)	
Date delivered	
Goal for the month (number of customer inquiries)	
Tracked keyword list: agreed on (date) / changes this month	
The client owns the Search Console and GA4 accounts	☐ yes ☐ no
GA4 key events (form, phone, email) are working	☐ yes ☐ no – if not, list it as a risk in section 5

What's inside

p. 2	Monthly summary: sections 1, 2, 4 and 5 on a single page
p. 3	Section 3: work log and links acquired
p. 4	Metrics table from GA4 and Search Console – months to fill in, how to read each metric and its pitfalls
p. 5	For the reader: five-section check and red flags

Monthly summary – page 1 of the report, clear without any attachments

1. Result against the goal

Metric	This month	Goal	Same month last year	YoY change
Customer inquiries from Google (form + phone + email)				
Cost per inquiry				

The result in three sentences: what it was, how it compares with the goal and which way the trend is heading.
e.g. "More Google inquiries than a year ago, but below goal. Form fills are up. The trend has been rising for 3 months."

2. What influenced the result: 3–5 causes, each with evidence

Evidence: a dated Search Console screenshot, the go-live date of a change, or an algorithm update confirmed by Google.

#	What changed	When	Pages	Evidence
e.g.	*New pricing section on the service page; clicks on price keywords rising since then*	*mid-month*	*service page*	*dated Search Console screenshot*
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				

Not good enough: "rankings went up thanks to optimization" – with no date and no page URL, it explains nothing.

3. Work done and its effect – the full dated list is in the work log on p. 3.

4. Plan for next month: the 3 most important tasks

#	Task and what it covers	Expected effect	How you will know
e.g.	*Pricing FAQ on the service page*	*more clicks on price keywords*	*Search Console, next report*
1			
2			
3			

Not good enough: a plan with a single item, "further optimization" – it gives you nothing to check in the next report.

5. Risks and needs

Risk or need	What is needed and from whom	By when
Technical fixes are waiting for a developer	*developer access – client*	*date*

3. Work done and its effect

A dated list of work: new content, technical fixes, links acquired, changes to the Google Business Profile. For each item, name the page it concerns and say whether the effect is visible yet. Each entry should make clear what exactly was changed.

Date	Type	What exactly changed	Page (URL)	Hrs	Effect
e.g. Oct 14	*content*	*Pricing section on the service page*	*service page URL*		*visible: clicks on price keywords rising*
					☐ visible ☐ not yet
					☐ visible ☐ not yet
					☐ visible ☐ not yet
					☐ visible ☐ not yet
					☐ visible ☐ not yet
					☐ visible ☐ not yet
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					☐ visible ☐ not yet
					☐ visible ☐ not yet
					☐ visible ☐ not yet
					☐ visible ☐ not yet

Type: content, technical, link, Business Profile. **Not good enough:** task names alone, such as “on-page optimization,” with nothing about what changed or where.

Hours this month (if you pay by the hour): _____ of _____ in the contract

Links acquired

For every link: the URL, the date and its current status. Quality counts, not the number of links.

Linking page URL	Date	Target page	Link still live
			☐ yes ☐ no
			☐ yes ☐ no
			☐ yes ☐ no
			☐ yes ☐ no
			☐ yes ☐ no

Metrics table (appendix)

Fill it in with data from GA4 and Google Search Console, and write the month names in the column headers. Count clicks and impressions without brand queries: in the Search Console Performance report, add a query filter that excludes your company name and its variants, including misspellings.

Metric	**Source**	**Month** _____	**Month** _____	**Month** _____	**Last year** same month	**Change** YoY
Customer inquiries from Google – total	GA4: key events					
of which: form	GA4					
of which: phone	GA4					
of which: email	GA4					
Cost per inquiry (monthly SEO cost ÷ number of inquiries)	invoices, GA4					
Clicks excluding brand queries	Search Console					
Impressions excluding brand queries	Search Console					
Agreed keywords in the TOP 3 (%)	Search Console or a rank tracker					
Agreed keywords in the TOP 10 (%)	Search Console or a rank tracker					
Business Profile: 7×7 grid points in the TOP 3 (%)	49-point measurement					
AI answers that name the company (%)	fixed set of questions, weekly					
Links acquired: new / still live	link list (p. 3)					

How to read the metrics and where the pitfalls are

Metric	**Source**	**How to read it**	**Pitfall**
Inquiries from Google (form, phone, email) and the cost per inquiry	GA4 (key events), invoices	The main result of the month	Without key events set up, this number does not exist
Clicks and impressions excluding brand queries	Google Search Console	Year-over-year trend	Brand queries inflate the result
Rankings of keywords from the agreed list	Search Console or a rank tracker	Share of keywords in the TOP 3 and TOP 10	With many keywords, the average position is misleading
Business Profile position in Maps	Measurement from 49 points (7×7 grid)	Percentage of points in the TOP 3	A single check from the office is a coincidence
Visibility in ChatGPT and AI Overviews	A fixed set of customer questions, weekly	Percentage of answers that name the company	A single question proves nothing
Links acquired	A list with the URL, date and status	Whether the link is still on the page	A link count that ignores link quality

Measure the Business Profile on a grid of points around the company address, because customers see different Maps results depending on where they are. ChatGPT answers change from day to day, so measure AI visibility with a fixed set of questions asked on a regular schedule. Record every change to the tracked keyword list in the report.

For the reader: check your agency's report

Fill this in after every report. Missing sections and ticked flags are your questions for the next meeting.

Does the report have all five sections?

Section	Month: _____	Month: _____	Month: _____
1. Result against the goal: inquiries, cost, goal, year-over-year comparison	☐	☐	☐
2. 3–5 causes of change, each with evidence and a date	☐	☐	☐
3. Work log with dates and page URLs	☐	☐	☐
4. Plan: 3 tasks with the expected effect and how to check it	☐	☐	☐
5. Risks and needs, including what the agency needs from you	☐	☐	☐

Red flags

☐ **No number of customer inquiries.**
The report talks about traffic and rankings, but not about how many customers got in touch. Without key events in GA4, nobody knows whether SEO pays off.

☐ **Rankings without a keyword list agreed at the start.**
The agency shows keywords where the site already ranks high, not the ones you agreed on. It is easy to build growth from such keywords that means nothing for sales.

☐ **"Visibility" with no definition or source.**
Without the name of the tool, the method and the keyword list, you cannot verify a visibility chart or compare it with the previous period.

☐ **No dated list of work done.**
If you do not know what was done and when, you cannot link a change in results to the agency's work or to anything else.

☐ **No year-over-year comparison.**
Month-over-month growth during peak season is often just the calendar, not the effect of SEO.

☐ **Data only in a PDF.**
A report is no substitute for access to Search Console and Analytics on your own account. Without it, you are left with no data history when the contract ends.

How to score it: one flag is a reason to ask questions; several at once are a reason to talk about changing agencies. Some flags come from convenience rather than bad intent, so start with a conversation and ask for a report based on this template.

Questions for your next meeting

Want an outside view of your previous agency's reports? Book a free 30-minute online review: kontakt@ai-seo-company.pl, +48 518 815 055.